TEAM BRIEF · EDUVOS CHALLENGE ENTRY

CAMPUSCART

Your campus, open for business.

A quick guide to what CampusCart is, everything it does, and how close it is to launch.

FOR
The CampusCart team

BY
Lama Nkuna

AS OF
22 October 2026

01 WHAT IT IS

CampusCart is an online marketplace for Eduvos students. Students buy, sell and swap textbooks, tech, food, services and more with other students on their own campus.

Think of it as a **safer, campus-only Facebook Marketplace**, run with the Eduvos Incubation Hub.

Why students would use it instead of WhatsApp groups

Checked sellers

The Incubation Hub approves every shop before it can sell. Shops earn trust badges from how they treat buyers.

Safe meet-ups

Buyers and sellers meet at approved pickup spots on campus. You see the item before you pay.

Private chat

Messages stay inside the app, so nobody has to share a phone number. The app warns people about common scams.

Who uses it

Students buying

Find things on their campus, save favourites, message sellers, get alerts, and post what they're looking for.

Student sellers

Open a shop, list items with photos, reply to buyers, and see how their shop is doing from their own Selling section.

Hub mentors

Look after a set of shops, keep private notes, run office hours, and post tips and events.

Hub admins

Approve shops, deal with reports, choose featured shops, give staff roles, watch the weekly numbers, and keep the marketplace safe.

02 WHAT STUDENTS CAN DO

Shop

- Browse every campus, or just your own
- Search, and filter by category, price and how you pay, including free items and swaps
- Collections and Featured shops picked by the Hub
- See photos, prices and where to collect each item
- Save items and follow favourite shops
- Save a search and get an alert when a match is listed

Sell

- Set up a shop in a few simple steps, then the Hub approves it
- List items with up to 6 photos
- Mark items as sold, pause them, or relist them
- A Selling section with its own menu: overview, listings, messages and your shop
- See enquiries, reply times, sales and a trust badge that grows over time
- See how many people follow your shop (never who)
- Free to sell, and CampusCart takes no cut

Ask and offer ("Looking For")

- Post what you need, like "graphing calculator, under R300"
- Shops reply with offers, straight into a private chat
- Requests never show your name, only your campus
- Edit or close a request yourself
- Old requests close by themselves, with a reminder two days before

The Incubation Hub

- Events, office hours and selling tips in one place
- RSVP to events, or book time with a mentor
- See which shops the Hub has verified

Talk and stay safe

- Message sellers and offer swaps
- Safety tips beside every message, and warnings about scam words
- Confirm a sale once it's done
- Report a listing, shop, request or message
- Notifications for messages, offers, alerts and Hub decisions

Your account ("You")

- Sign in with your student email and a one-time code (no password)
- Stay signed in for 30 days on your own phone
- Download everything the app holds about you
- Delete your account in one step

03 BEHIND THE SCENES

For Hub mentors

- A Mentoring section with its own menu
- Each mentored shop's enquiries, reply times, sales and flags over 14 days
- Private notes and check-ins about a shop (never shown to the seller)
- Office hours: answer students' slot requests
- Post tips and events to the Hub
- Download their shops' numbers as a spreadsheet

For Hub admins

- A Hub console that opens on what needs attention today
- Approve, decline or pause shops
- Handle reports: hide a listing or request, or pause a shop, and show it again later
- Choose Featured shops and manage pickup spots
- Give or remove mentor and admin roles, by exact email only
- Weekly numbers by campus, with small counts hidden to protect privacy
- A log of every staff action, which can't be edited

Fair and safe by design

- No admin decides on their own shop or request
- The last admin can't be removed
- Limits stop spam: new chats per day and messages per hour
- Sign-in codes allow 5 tries, and code emails are limited
- Photos lose their hidden location data before they're stored

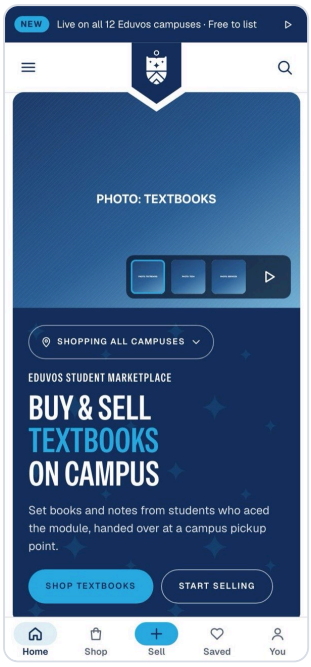
Privacy (POPIA)

- Collects only what it needs
- The privacy page names every cookie and every service that holds data
- Deleting an account removes its requests, follows, saved searches and notes about it
- Saved searches are seen only by their owner

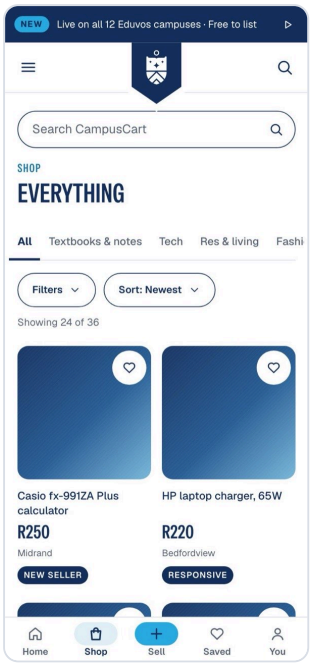
Built for students' phones

- Fast on cheap phones and mobile data, with a data-saver mode that skips photos.
- A bottom tab bar on phones. Selling, mentoring and the Hub console each get their own menu, which becomes a sidebar on a laptop.
- Smooth page changes, switched off for anyone who asks their phone for less motion.
- Can be added to the home screen like an app, with a friendly page when the signal drops.
- Built to meet international accessibility standards (WCAG 2.2 AA).

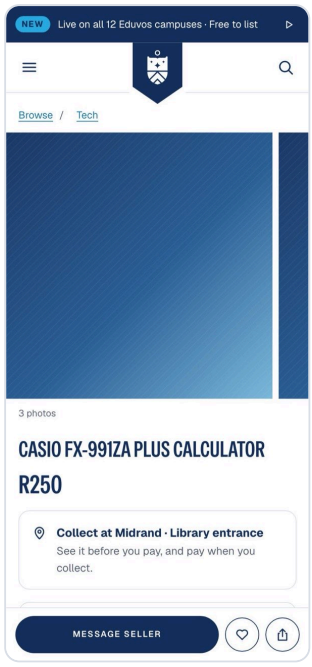
04 A LOOK AT THE APP



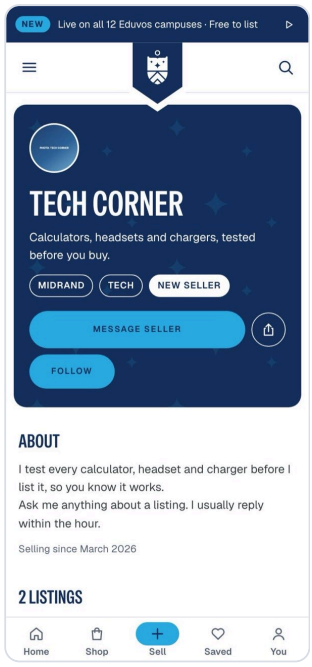
Homepage



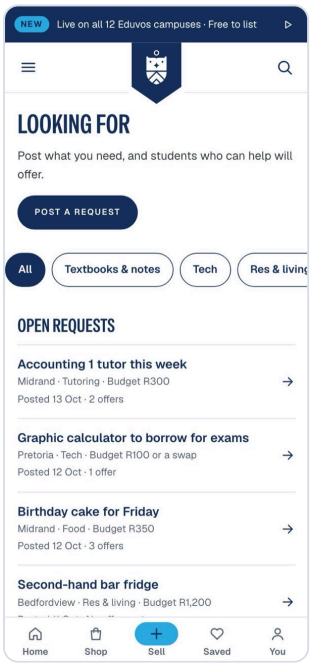
Browse and filter



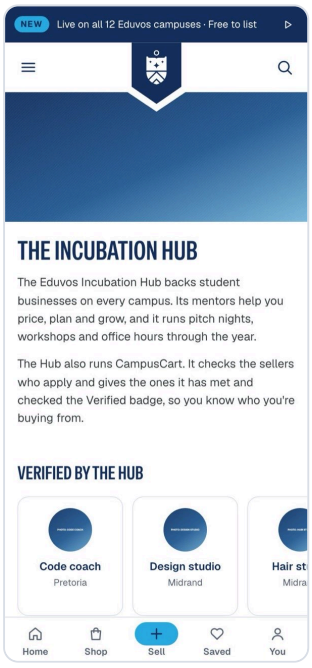
An item



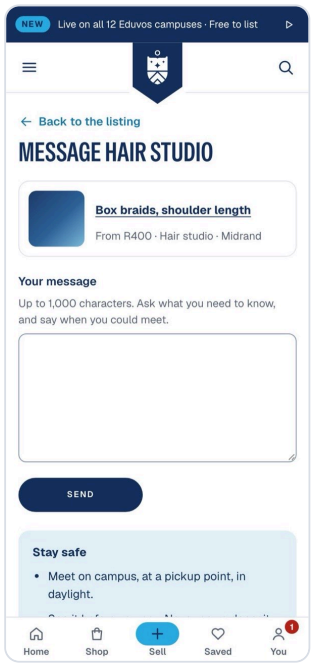
A student's shop



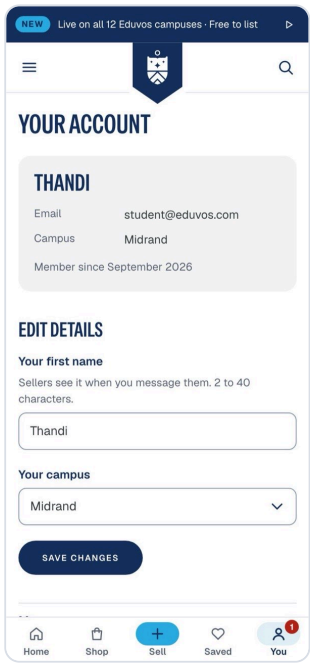
Looking For



Incubation Hub



Messaging a seller

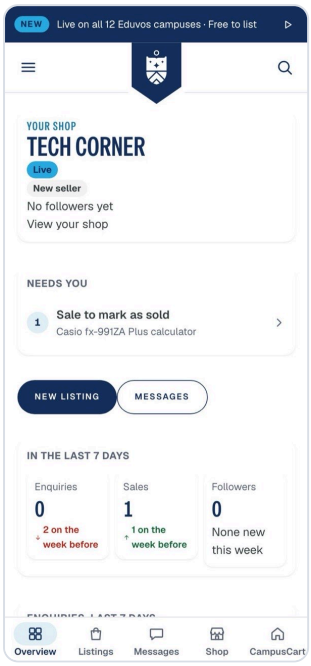


Your account

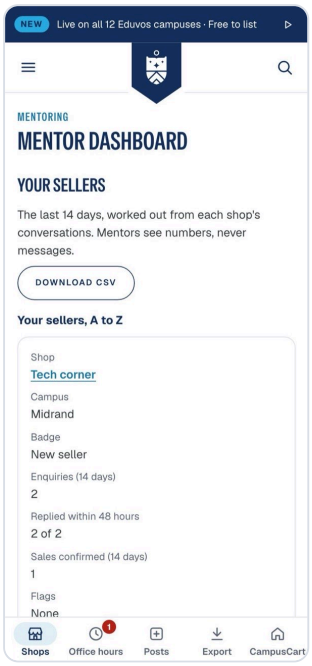
Taken on 22 October 2026 at phone size, on sample data. The photos are placeholders until real ones arrive.

05 SELLING AND THE HUB TEAM

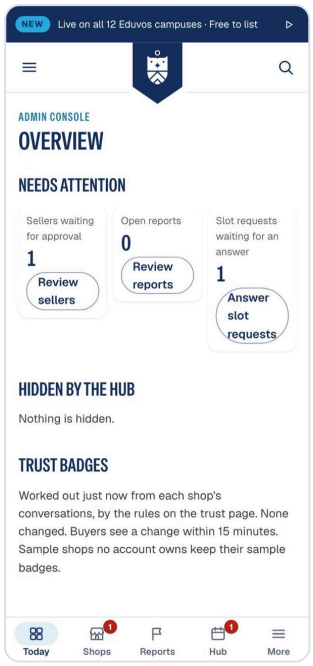
Sellers, mentors and admins each get their own section, with its own menu along the bottom of the phone.



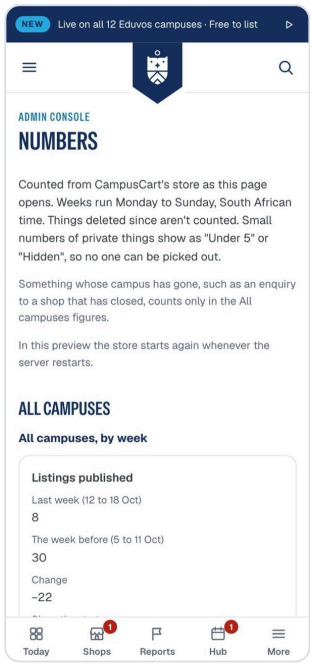
Seller's home (new, in progress)



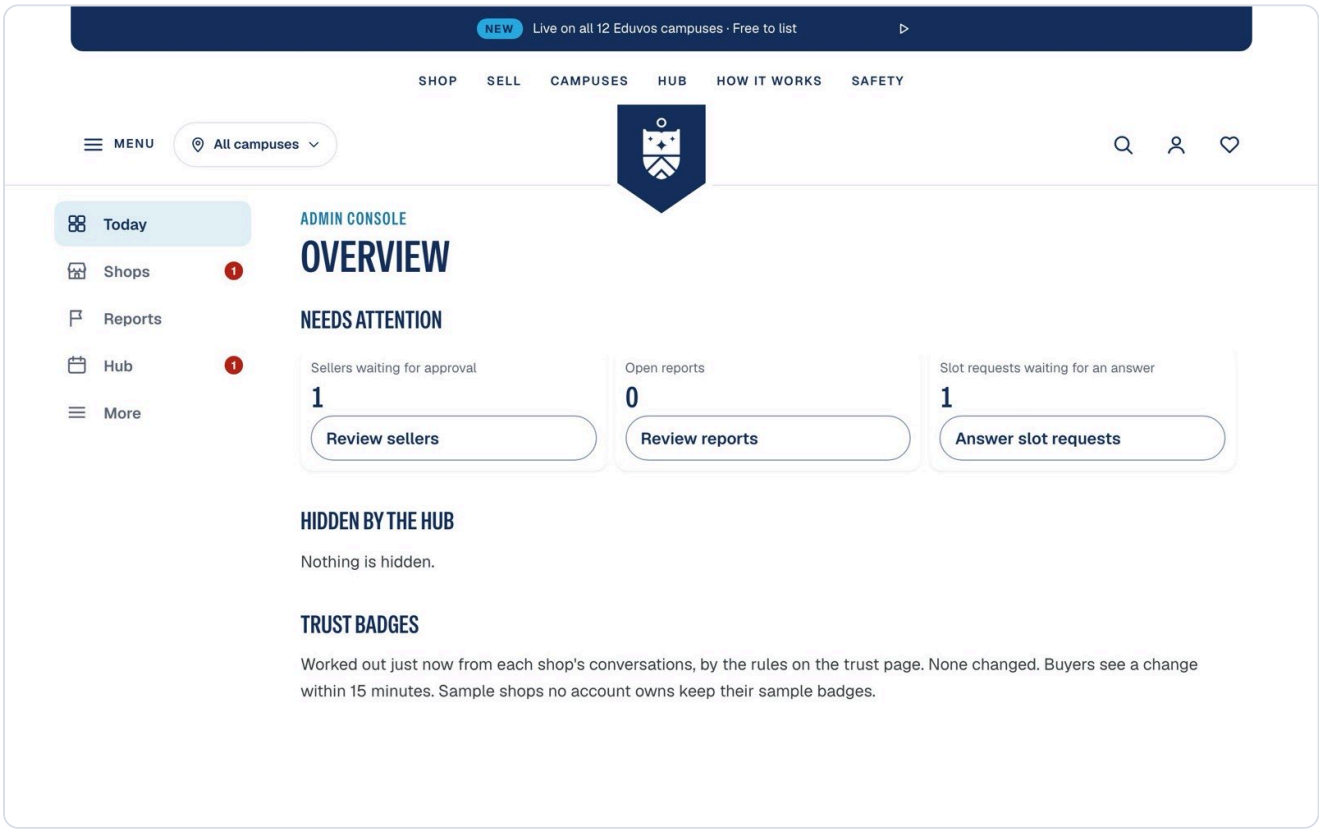
Mentor dashboard



Hub console: Today



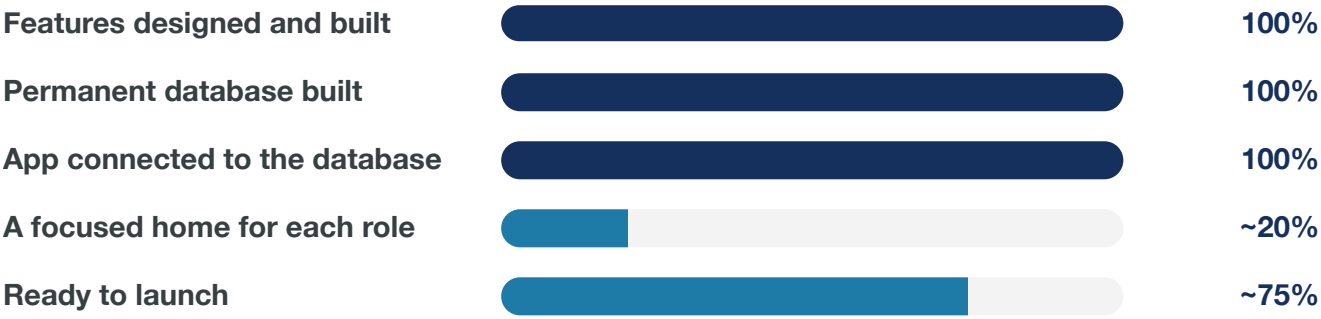
The weekly numbers



On a laptop, the section's menu becomes a sidebar

06 WHERE WE ARE

Every feature is built, tested and running on the permanent database. The team preview already uses it. What's left is a focused home page for each role, switching on email, and opening it to real students.



The percentages are estimates from the build plans.

Done

- All shopping, selling, messaging and community features
- The Hub's tools for mentors and admins
- Privacy, safety and accessibility
- Everything on the permanent database, with the team preview using it
- The new name, and section menus for each role

In progress

- A focused home for each role, step 2 of 5: the seller's home

Next

- Focused homes for admins, mentors and students
- Sign-in codes sent by email
- Final setup of the live database
- Testing on real phones
- Going live

In numbers

13
campuses: 12 plus Eduvos Online

60+
screens built

6,000+
automatic checks that run on every change

10
shopping categories

07 THE ROAD TO LAUNCH

1. **Finish the focused homes.** Each role opens on what matters to them: a seller's shop at a glance, an admin's "needs you today", a mentor's shops, and a student's own page.
2. **Set up the live database.** Load its final structure, clear out the sample data, and make the first admin.
3. **Turn on email.** Students receive their sign-in code by email.
4. **Test on real phones.** Check the app on a cheap Android phone and on an iPhone.
5. **Add real content.** Real photos, real Hub events and office hours, the real mentors and admins, and enough shops listed so the app doesn't open empty.
6. **Go live.** Switch off the demo accounts, let search engines find the site, and open CampusCart to students, possibly starting with one campus as a pilot.

Decisions the team can help with

- Launch on all campuses at once, or start with a pilot campus?
- Should new messages and alerts also be sent by email, or stay in the app?
- How long should messages, reports and notifications be kept?
- Which email address should students use for privacy requests and support?

Try it

The team preview runs at **vossie-pi.vercel.app**, on the permanent database. That's the working name, and the address changes later. On the sign-in page, pick a demo account to look around as a student, a seller, a mentor or an admin. You don't need a code. The demo sellers start without a shop there, so you can try opening one. The demo accounts and their data are cleared before launch.